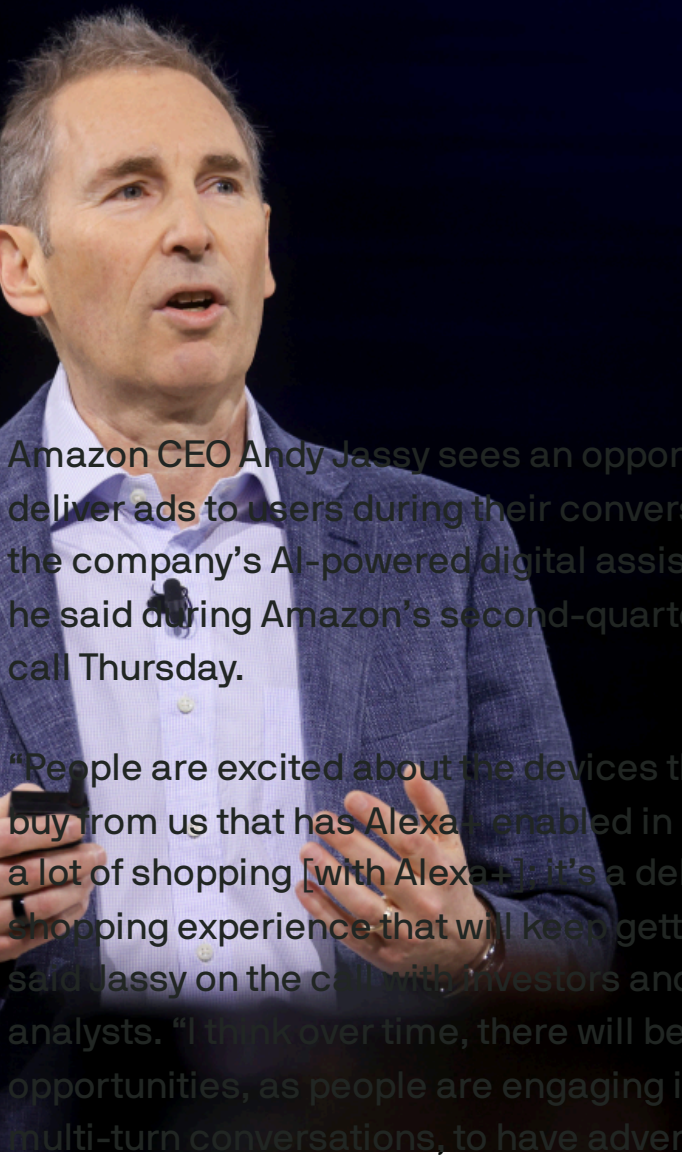


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AI



# Amazon CEO wants to put ads in your Alexa+ conversations



Amazon CEO Andy Jassy sees an opportunity to deliver ads to users during their conversations with the company's AI-powered digital assistant, [Alexa+](#), he said during Amazon's second-quarter earnings call Thursday.

"People are excited about the devices that they can buy from us that has Alexa+ enabled in it. People do a lot of shopping [with Alexa+]; it's a delightful shopping experience that will keep getting better," said Jassy on the call with investors and Wall Street analysts. "I think over time, there will be opportunities, as people are engaging in more multi-turn conversations, to have advertising play a role to help people find discovery, and also as a lever to drive revenue."

IMAGE CREDITS:

MICHAEL NAGLE / BLOOMBERG / GETTY IMAGES

Amazon says it has rolled out Alexa+ to millions of customers, part of an effort to make its legacy digital assistant capable of agentic behaviors and more natural to talk to. Alexa+ is Amazon's answer to generative AI voice assistants from [OpenAI](#), [Google](#), and [Perplexity](#) that have made legacy systems feel outdated. However, the business models behind generative AI products remain unclear.

Amazon has made Alexa+ free for Prime customers (who pay \$14.99 a month) and added a \$20-a-month subscription tier for Alexa+ on its own. Jassy suggested on Thursday that Alexa+ could eventually include subscription tiers beyond what's available today — perhaps an ad-free tier.

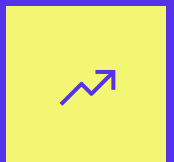
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Up until now, ads have only appeared in Alexa in limited ways. Users may occasionally see a visual ad on Amazon’s smart display device, the Echo Show, or hear a pre-recorded ad in between songs on one of Alexa’s smart speakers.

But Jassy’s description of an AI-generated ad that Alexa+ delivers in a multistep conversation, which could help users find new products, is uncharted territory for Amazon and the broader tech industry. Marketers have expressed interest in advertising in AI chatbots, and [specifically Alexa+](#), but exactly how remains unclear.

Amazon’s competitors in the AI space seem to think advertising is a promising business model for generative AI, too. Google is exploring how to [infuse ads](#) into its AI-powered search experience, AI mode. OpenAI CEO Sam Altman said he’s open to a “[tasteful](#)” form of advertising in ChatGPT.

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Amazon is spending a fortune to catch up in the AI race. In the second quarter of 2025, Amazon’s

capital expenditures rose to \$31.4 billion, up 90% from the same period last year. A large part of that increased spending is to develop Amazon's in-house AI chips and build out data centers to support AI models. While the revenue of Amazon's cloud business, AWS, grew 18% in the second quarter, the company likely needs to generate new business to pay for these investments.

Jassy is betting that users will talk to Alexa+ more than Alexa, which could drive more advertising and more shopping on Amazon.com. However, [early reviews](#) of Alexa+ have been mixed. Amazon has reportedly [struggled to ship](#) some of Alexa+'s more complicated features, and the rollout has been [slower than many expected](#).

There's a lot to figure out before Amazon puts ads in Alexa+. Like most AI models, Alexa+ is not immune to hallucinations. Before advertisers agree to make Alexa+ a spokesperson for their products, Amazon may have to come up with some ways to ensure that its AI will not offer false advertising for a product.

Jassy seems enthusiastic about making advertising a larger part of Amazon business. Amazon's advertising revenue went up 22% in the second quarter, compared to the same period last year.

Delivering ads in AI chatbot conversations may also raise privacy concerns. People tend to talk more with AI chatbots compared to deterministic assistants, like the traditional Alexa and Siri products. As a result, generative AI chatbots tend to collect more information on users. Some users might be unsettled by having that information sold to advertisers and having ads appear in their natural language conversations with AI.

Topics: [AI](#) [alexa+](#) [Amazon](#) [earnings](#)



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Maxwell Zeff is a senior reporter at TechCrunch specializing in AI. Previously with Gizmodo, Bloomberg, and MSNBC,...

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Amazon’s upgraded digital assistant powered by generative AI, Alexa+, has rolled out to over 100,000 users, CEO Andy Jassy said on the company’s earnings call Thursday.

While that’s a far cry from the 600 million Alexa devices out there, the company is making some progress on the rollout of Alexa+, which was [first unveiled in February](#). At the time, Amazon said that Alexa+ would roll out in waves over the coming months.

Amazon’s new digital assistant aims to let users talk with it in a more natural style and eventually have agentic abilities that allow it to use third-party apps on a user’s behalf. Alexa+ should be able to generate original responses on the fly, much like the voice modes in OpenAI’s ChatGPT and Google’s Gemini, rather than the predetermined responses of the old Alexa and Siri systems.

However, as The Washington Post reported at launch, the Alexa+ that’s rolling out today [lacks some of the key features the company demoed in February](#). The report notes that, at launch, Alexa+ did not have the ability to use third-party apps like GrubHub, generate a bedtime story for children, or brainstorm a gift idea. It’s unclear when those features will make it into Alexa+.

“We have a lot more functionality that we plan to add in coming months,” Jassy said on the call.

During his opening comments, Jassy claimed that Alexa+ is one of the first action-oriented AI agents for consumers. But he noted that this technology is still rather “primitive” and “inaccurate.” Currently, most multi-step AI agents have a low accuracy rate, between 30% and 60%, the Amazon CEO said. Jassy set a goal for the company’s web-browsing agent that powers Alexa+, [Nova Act](#), to achieve 90% accuracy in this domain.

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Amazon's rollout of Alexa+ seems to be progressing faster than Apple's rollout of its new, LLM-powered Siri. When asked about the new Siri delays on Apple's Thursday earnings call, which occurred simultaneously with Amazon's, CEO Tim Cook said the company needed "[more time to complete the work.](#)"



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Along the road to supercharge legacy digital assistants with generative AI, both Apple and Amazon have [reportedly run into snags and delays](#). Some of the biggest hiccups are around getting LLMs to use tools and integrate with other systems. Doing so allows Alexa and Siri to complete practical tasks such as setting timers and reading texts, but implementing it has proven harder than expected.

Topics: [AI](#) [Alexa](#) [alexa+](#) [Amazon](#) [Hardware](#)





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Senior AI Reporter |

Maxwell Zeff is a senior reporter at TechCrunch specializing in AI. Previously with Gizmodo, Bloomberg, and MSNBC,...

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IMAGE CREDITS: AMAZON

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## Amazon brings its AI-powered image generator to Fire TV

Lauren Forristal — 6:00 AM PST · January 17, 2024

Amazon is officially rolling out the ability to create AI-generated images on Fire TV devices. Starting today, the feature is available in the U.S. for users

Latest in AI

with a second-generation Fire TV Stick 4K Max and Fire TV Omni QLED Series.

Fire TV's new feature is powered by Amazon's Titan Image Generator, which the company [announced](#) during its [AWS re:Invent 2023 conference](#) in November. Like other image generators (Stability AI and OpenAI's DALL-E 3), the Titan model takes a written prompt and turns the text into an image. However, in this case, the Fire TV AI feature is triggered by speaking to Alexa with the TV remote, allowing users to craft images with their own voice.

For instance, users can say, "Alexa, create a background of a fairy landscape." It then generates four images that users can further customize by choosing from various artistic styles like impressionistic, watercolor and fantasy. After picking a final image, users can save it and set it as their TV background.

While the Titan model has the ability to customize existing images, Fire TV's feature won't have that capability at launch. Amazon wouldn't give us an update on when users would be able to input personal photos into the generator.

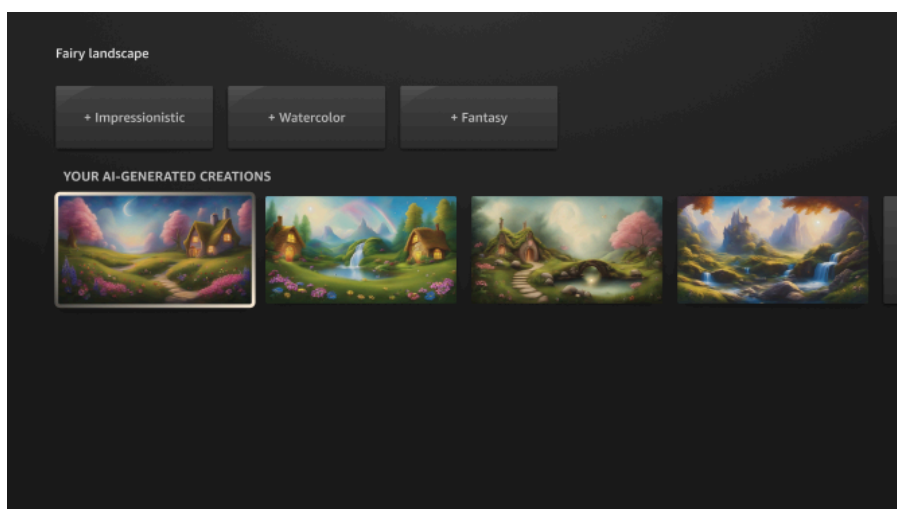


IMAGE CREDITS: AMAZON

The image generator is part of the Fire TV Ambient Experience, which turns the TV into a smart display that features backgrounds made by artists or personal photos from an Amazon Photos account.

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The company recently introduced the experience to the Fire TV Stick 4K Max after already being available in Amazon’s Omni QLED lineup of Fire TVs.

Amazon [revealed](#) a handful of Fire TV-related updates at its [2023 devices event](#), such as improved voice search for users to ask Alexa more specific questions like finding titles based on cast, directors and genres or even describing a movie scene.

Today’s announcement also comes on the heels of Amazon [introducing](#) three new generative AI-powered Alexa experiences, including playing the “20 Questions” game, speaking with AI characters and creating custom songs.



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[Amazon’s Alexa gets new generative AI-powered experiences](#)

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**Lauren Forristal**



Lauren covers media, streaming, apps and platforms at TechCrunch.

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